

18

A Lifetime Najdorf Repertoire

An integrated decision tree, model rehearsals, and a repair system for keeping theory manageable.



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

You will leave with a coherent Black repertoire, a review schedule, and a method for adding theory only when your own games demand it.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate Black's candidates, find White's strongest reply, and choose the resulting structure you understand. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 103 | PAGE 4

Decode: Main-line rehearsal*Store structures and decisions; use move order only to reach them safely.*

LESSON 104 | PAGE 8

Play: Main-line rehearsal*Store structures and decisions; use move order only to reach them safely.*

LESSON 105 | PAGE 12

Decode: Anti-Sicilian decision tree*Name White's center first; the anti-Sicilian label comes second.*

LESSON 106 | PAGE 16

Play: Anti-Sicilian decision tree*Name White's center first; the anti-Sicilian label comes second.*

LESSON 107 | PAGE 20

Decode: Repairing the repertoire from your games*Repair the first unexplained decision, then test it again.*

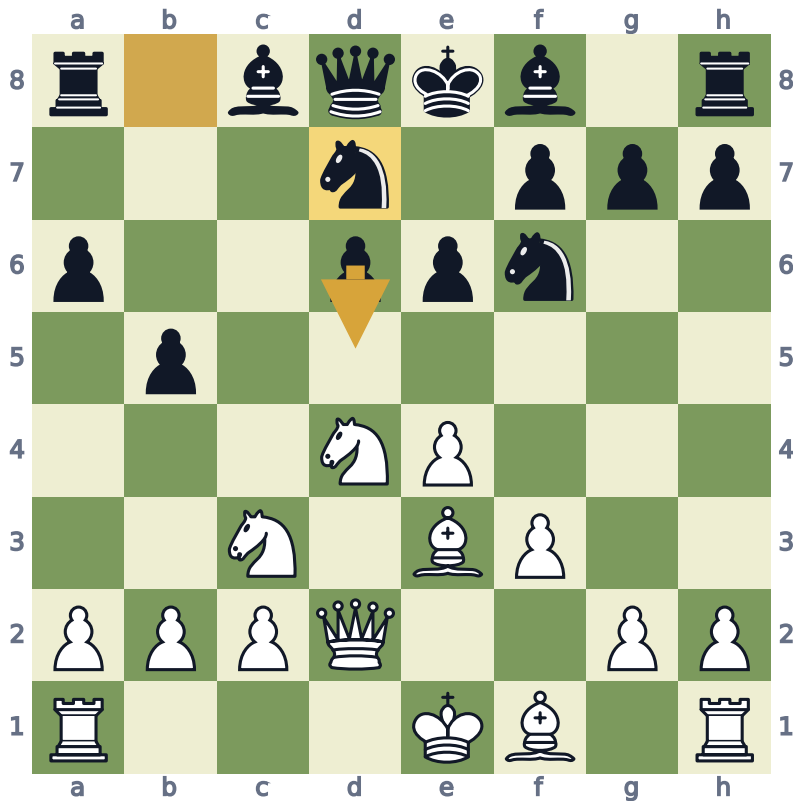
LESSON 108 | PAGE 24

Play: Repairing the repertoire from your games*Repair the first unexplained decision, then test it again.***VOLUME OBJECTIVE**

You will leave with a coherent Black repertoire, a review schedule, and a method for adding theory only when your own games demand it.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Main-line rehearsal



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The repertoire backbone links development, ...b5, control of d5, the c-file, and a central break into one causal chain.

DECISION RULE

Which move is essential to the position, and which move belongs only to the memorized order?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Reach a known structure, identify White's attack, and choose the move that changes the race rather than merely following a memorized sequence.

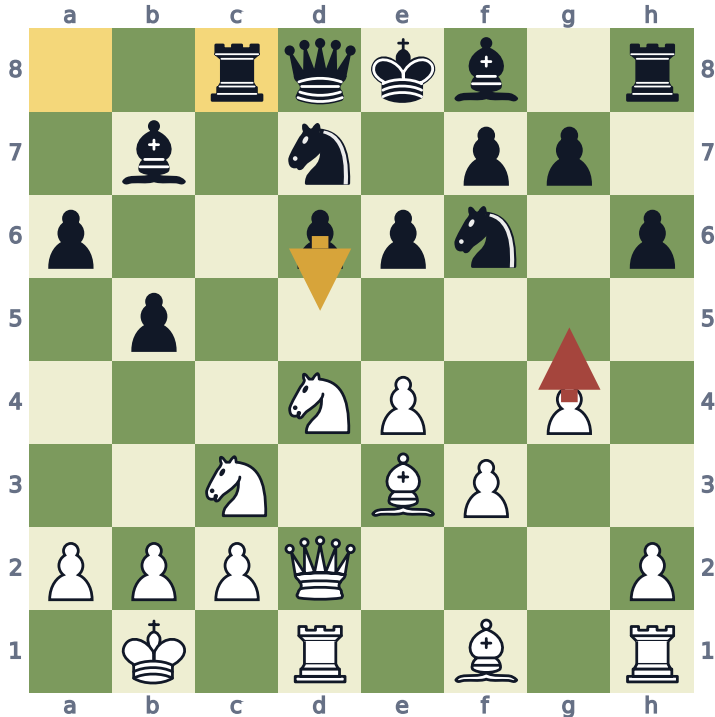
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White varies move order to make Black reveal commitments or lose a tempo in the attack.

MEMORY RULE | Store structures and decisions; use move order only to reach them safely.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The repertoire backbone links development, ...b5, control of d5, the c-file, and a central break into one causal chain.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Reach a known structure, identify White's attack, and choose the move that changes the race rather than merely following a memorized sequence.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White varies move order to make Black reveal commitments or lose a tempo in the attack.

FAILURE MODE

Trying to reproduce a line after White has changed one detail that alters the tactics.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which move is essential to the position, and which move belongs only to the memorized order? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

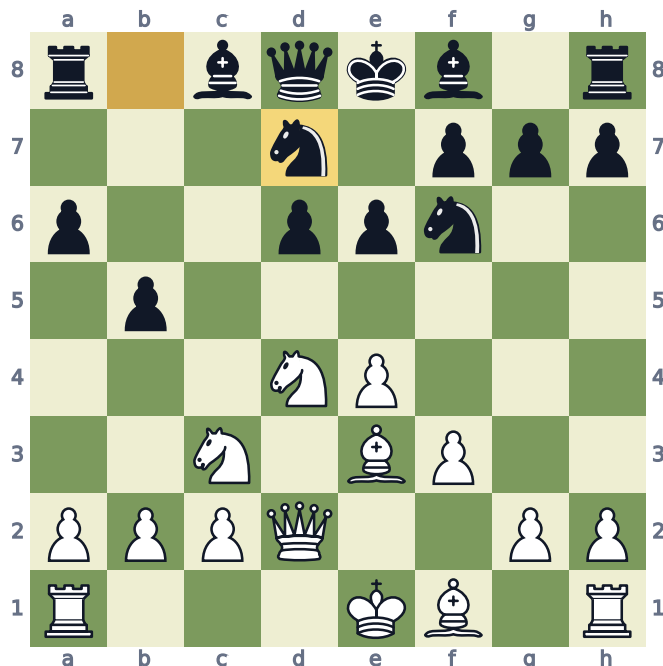
RULE | Store structures and decisions; use move order only to reach them safely.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be3 e6 7. f3 b5 8. Qd2 Nbd7 9. g4 h6 10. O-O-O Bb7 11. Kb1 Rc8



- Be3: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- e6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- f3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- b5: Black starts queenside expansion and prepares files or a bishop diagonal.
- Qd2: White coordinates several plans, but the queen's safety and the opponent's forcing reply must be checked.
- Nbd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The repertoire backbone links development, ...b5, control of d5, the c-file, and a central break into one causal chain.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which move is essential to the position, and which move belongs only to the memorized order? White's resistance is: White varies move order to make Black reveal commitments or lose a tempo in the attack. The line fails as a template when: Trying to reproduce a line after White has changed one detail that alters the tactics.

STORE THIS | Store structures and decisions; use move order only to reach them safely.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

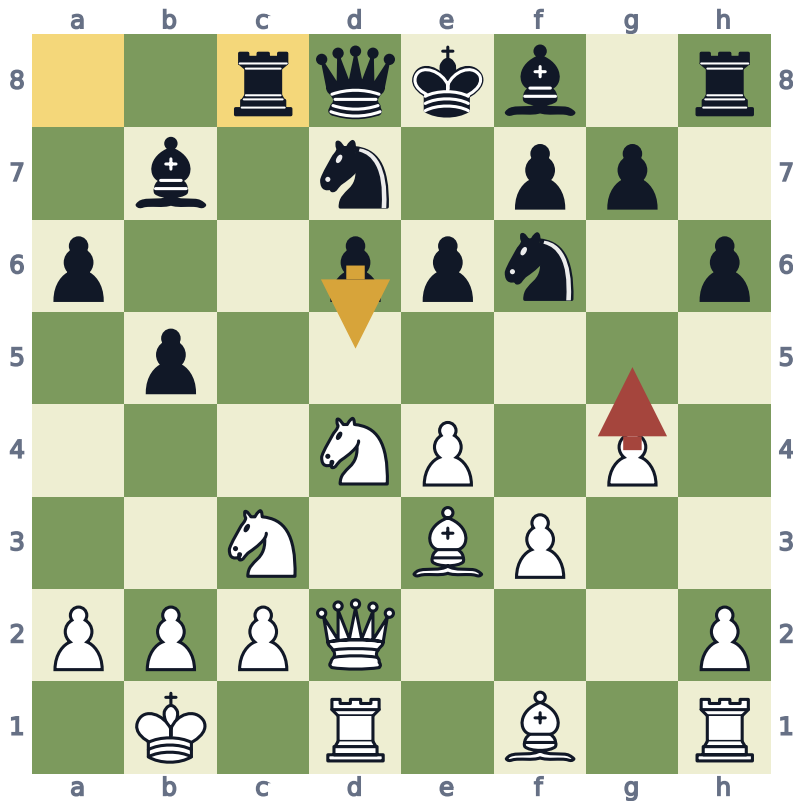
1. The repertoire backbone links development, ...b5, control of d5, the c-file, and a central break into one causal chain. 2. Reach a known structure, identify White's attack, and choose the move that changes the race rather than merely following a memorized sequence. 3. White varies move order to make Black reveal commitments or lose a tempo in the attack. 4. Which move is essential to the position, and which move belongs only to the memorized order? 5. Trying to reproduce a line after White has changed one detail that alters the tactics.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 16 plies from memory, then replay: 6. Be3 e6 7. f3 b5 8. Qd2 Nbd7

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Main-line rehearsal



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The repertoire backbone links development, ...b5, control of d5, the c-file, and a central break into one causal chain.

DECISION RULE

Which move is essential to the position, and which move belongs only to the memorized order?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Reach a known structure, identify White's attack, and choose the move that changes the race rather than merely following a memorized sequence.

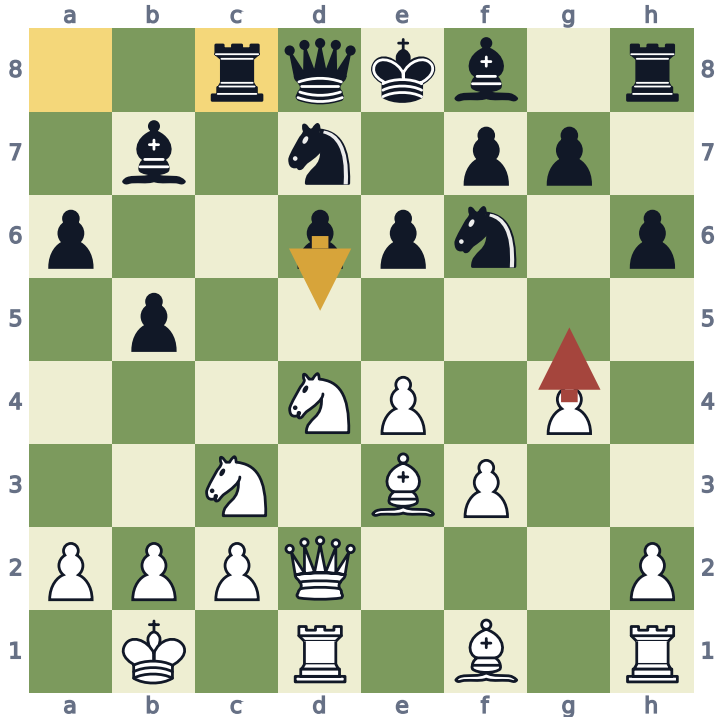
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White varies move order to make Black reveal commitments or lose a tempo in the attack.

MEMORY RULE | Store structures and decisions; use move order only to reach them safely.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The repertoire backbone links development, ...b5, control of d5, the c-file, and a central break into one causal chain.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Reach a known structure, identify White's attack, and choose the move that changes the race rather than merely following a memorized sequence.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White varies move order to make Black reveal commitments or lose a tempo in the attack.

FAILURE MODE

Trying to reproduce a line after White has changed one detail that alters the tactics.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which move is essential to the position, and which move belongs only to the memorized order? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

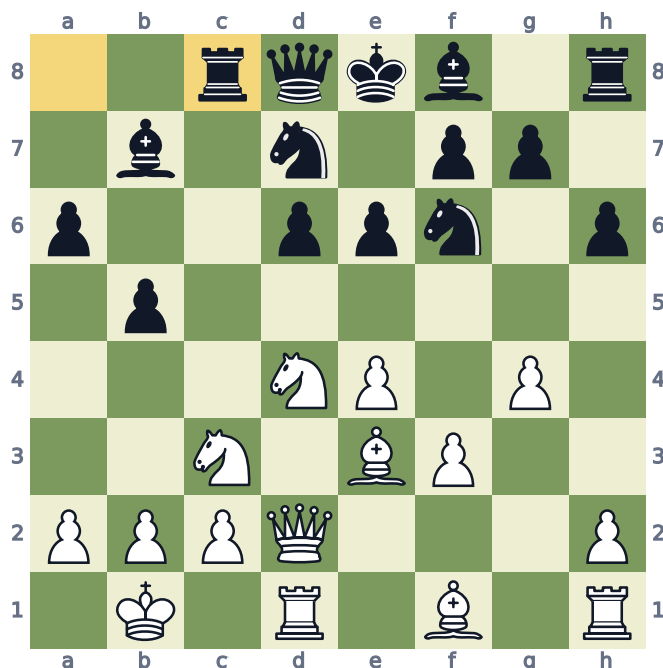
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be3 e6 7. f3 b5 8. Qd2 Nbd7 9. g4 h6 10. O-O-O Bb7 11. Kb1 Rc8



- g4: White starts a direct pawn storm and threatens to gain time on the f6 knight.
- h6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- O-O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- Bb7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Kb1: White improves coordination and changes the candidate set.
- Rc8: Black places a rook behind a file or pawn break expected to become important.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The repertoire backbone links development, ...b5, control of d5, the c-file, and a central break into one causal chain.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which move is essential to the position, and which move belongs only to the memorized order? White's resistance is: White varies move order to make Black reveal commitments or lose a tempo in the attack. The line fails as a template when: Trying to reproduce a line after White has changed one detail that alters the tactics.

STORE THIS | Store structures and decisions; use move order only to reach them safely.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

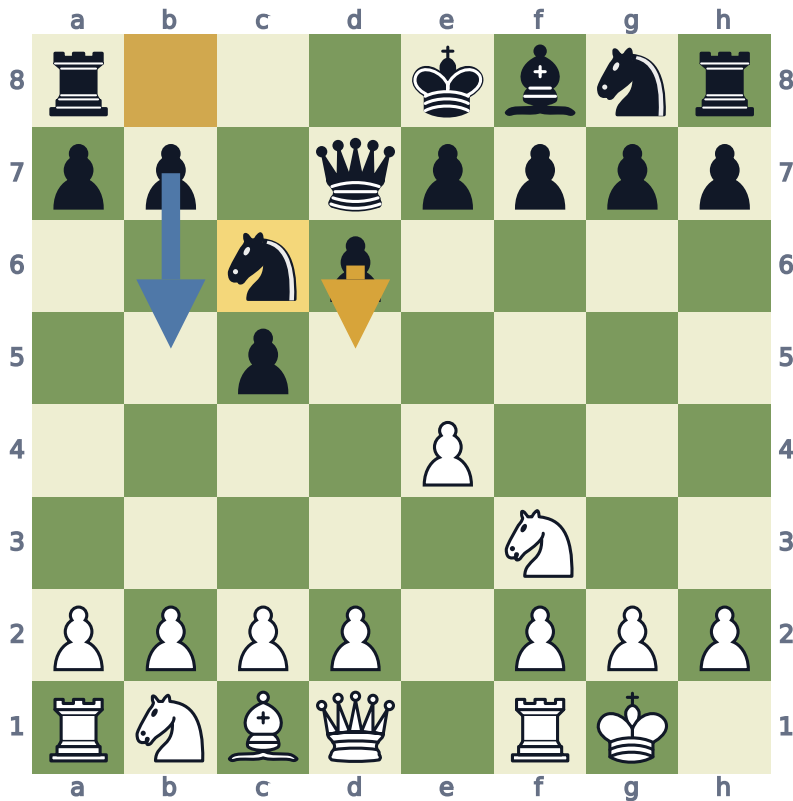
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 22 plies from memory, then replay: 9. g4 h6 10. O-O-O Bb7 11. Kb1 Rc8

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Anti-Sicilian decision tree



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Anti-Sicilians ask Black to identify White's intended center quickly: immediate d4, delayed d4, f4 attack, or gambit development.

DECISION RULE

What pawn break is White preparing, and which black move challenges it most directly?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Classify the center, choose the matching break, and develop without importing Najdorf moves into the wrong structure.

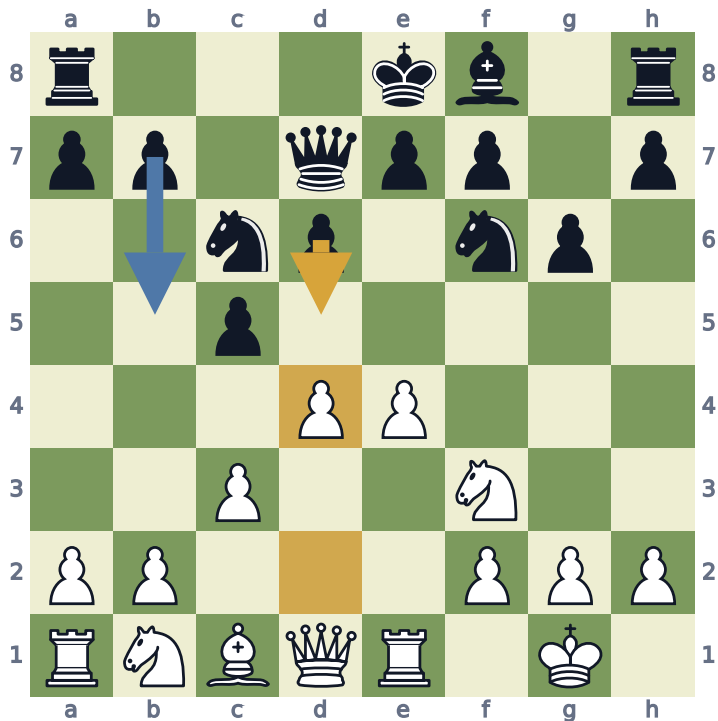
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White avoids main-line theory to obtain a familiar setup and practical initiative.

MEMORY RULE | Name White's center first; the anti-Sicilian label comes second.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Anti-Sicilians ask Black to identify White's intended center quickly: immediate d4, delayed d4, f4 attack, or gambit development.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Classify the center, choose the matching break, and develop without importing Najdorf moves into the wrong structure.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White avoids main-line theory to obtain a familiar setup and practical initiative.

FAILURE MODE

Feeling relieved to be out of theory and responding with generic moves instead of a concrete plan.

DECISION TEST

Ask: What pawn break is White preparing, and which black move challenges it most directly? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

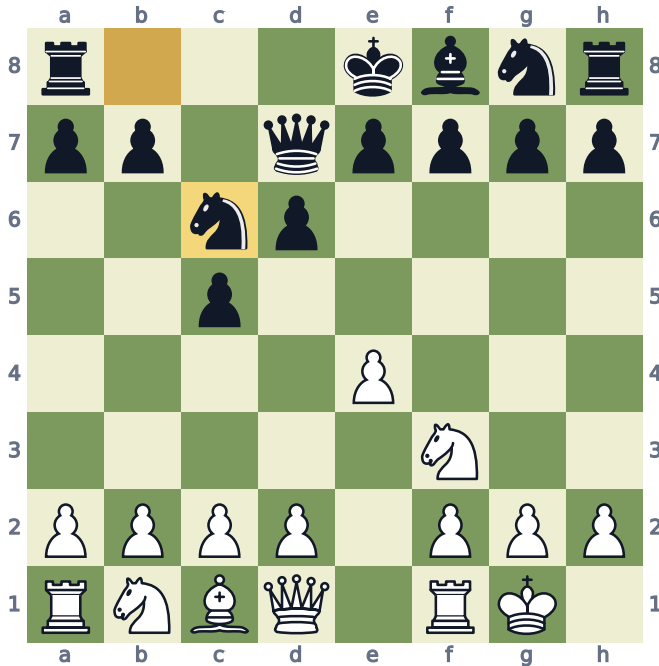
RULE | Name White's center first; the anti-Sicilian label comes second.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. Bb5+ Bd7 4. Bxd7+ Qxd7 5. O-O Nc6 6. c3 Nf6 7. Re1 g6 8. d4



- Bb5+: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Bd7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Bxd7+: White releases tension by capturing on d7; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Qxd7: Black releases tension by capturing on d7; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Anti-Sicilians ask Black to identify White's intended center quickly: immediate d4, delayed d4, f4 attack, or gambit development.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

What pawn break is White preparing, and which black move challenges it most directly? White's resistance is: White avoids main-line theory to obtain a familiar setup and practical initiative. The line fails as a template when: Feeling relieved to be out of theory and responding with generic moves instead of a concrete plan.

STORE THIS | Name White's center first; the anti-Sicilian label comes second.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

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ANSWER KEY

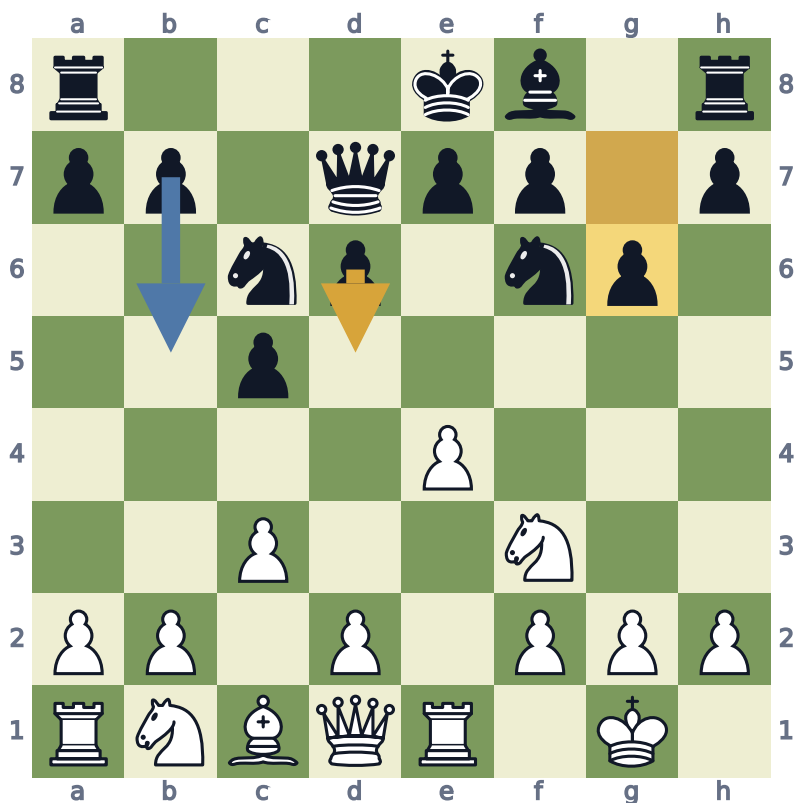
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 10 plies from memory, then replay: 3. Bb5+ Bd7 4. Bxd7+ Qxd7 5. O-O Nc6

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Anti-Sicilian decision tree



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Anti-Sicilians ask Black to identify White's intended center quickly: immediate d4, delayed d4, f4 attack, or gambit development.

DECISION RULE

What pawn break is White preparing, and which black move challenges it most directly?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Classify the center, choose the matching break, and develop without importing Najdorf moves into the wrong structure.

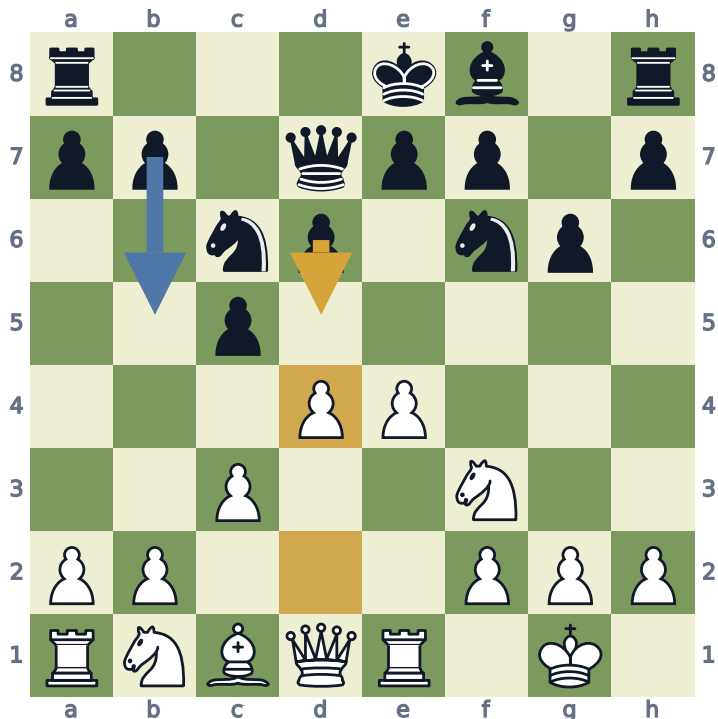
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White avoids main-line theory to obtain a familiar setup and practical initiative.

MEMORY RULE | Name White's center first; the anti-Sicilian label comes second.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Anti-Sicilians ask Black to identify White's intended center quickly: immediate d4, delayed d4, f4 attack, or gambit development.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Classify the center, choose the matching break, and develop without importing Najdorf moves into the wrong structure.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White avoids main-line theory to obtain a familiar setup and practical initiative.

FAILURE MODE

Feeling relieved to be out of theory and responding with generic moves instead of a concrete plan.

DECISION TEST

Ask: What pawn break is White preparing, and which black move challenges it most directly? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

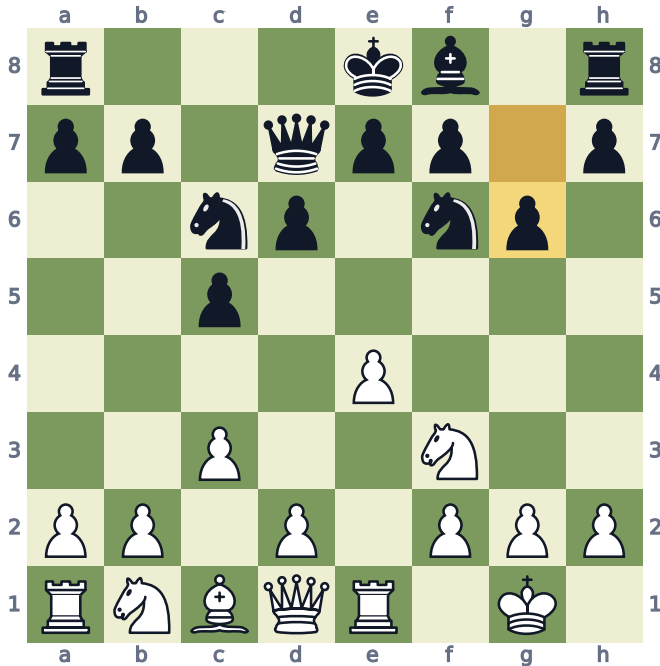
RULE | Name White's center first; the anti-Sicilian label comes second.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. Bb5+ Bd7 4. Bxd7+ Qxd7 5. O-O Nc6 6. c3 Nf6 7. Re1 g6 8. d4



- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- c3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight to f6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Re1: White places a rook behind a file or pawn break expected to become important.
- g6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Anti-Sicilians ask Black to identify White's intended center quickly: immediate d4, delayed d4, f4 attack, or gambit development.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

What pawn break is White preparing, and which black move challenges it most directly? White's resistance is: White avoids main-line theory to obtain a familiar setup and practical initiative. The line fails as a template when: Feeling relieved to be out of theory and responding with generic moves instead of a concrete plan.

STORE THIS | Name White's center first; the anti-Sicilian label comes second.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

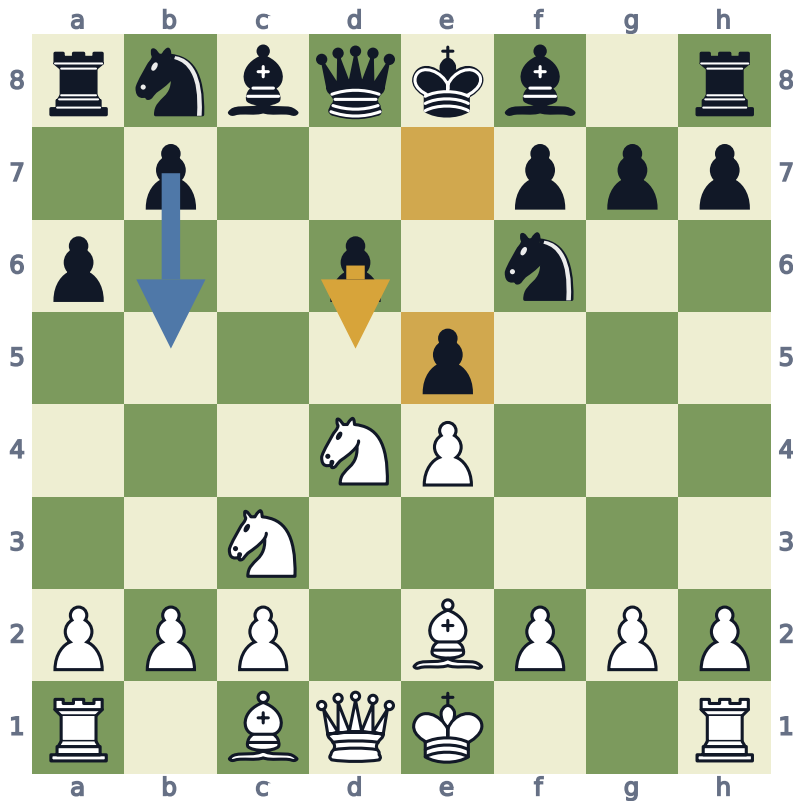
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 14 plies from memory, then replay: 5. O-O Nc6 6. c3 Nf6 7. Re1 g6

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Repairing the repertoire from your games



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

A lifetime repertoire grows from recurring decisions in your games, not from collecting every database branch at once.

DECISION RULE

At what move did your reasoning disappear, and what one decision rule would restore it next time?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

After each game, find the first position you could not explain, record the cue and candidate set, then repair only that branch.

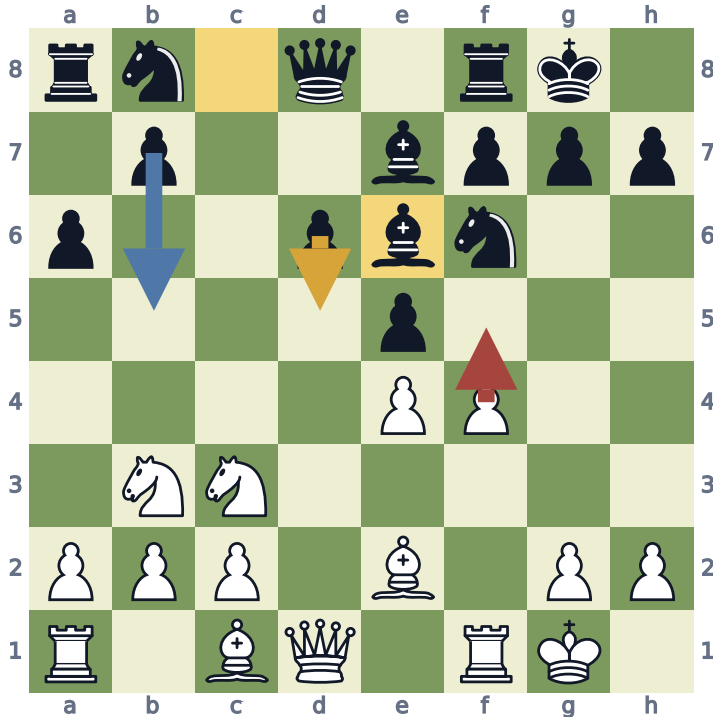
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

Opponents will choose sidelines and imperfect moves; those are tests of understanding rather than failures of preparation.

MEMORY RULE | Repair the first unexplained decision, then test it again.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

A lifetime repertoire grows from recurring decisions in your games, not from collecting every database branch at once.

BLACK AIMS FOR

After each game, find the first position you could not explain, record the cue and candidate set, then repair only that branch.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

Opponents will choose sidelines and imperfect moves; those are tests of understanding rather than failures of preparation.

FAILURE MODE

Replacing the whole opening after one loss or adding hundreds of moves without retrieval practice.

DECISION TEST

Ask: At what move did your reasoning disappear, and what one decision rule would restore it next time? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

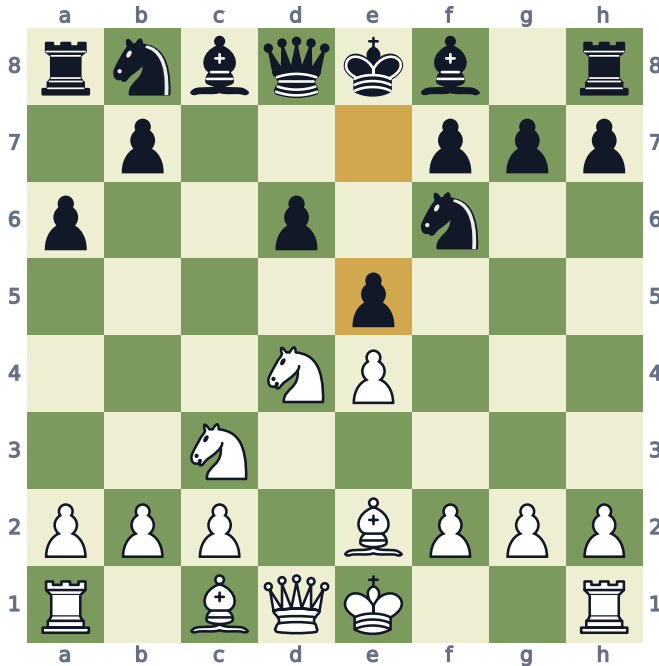
RULE | Repair the first unexplained decision, then test it again.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be2 e5 7. Nb3 Be7 8. O-O O-O 9. f4 Be6



- Nxd4: White releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight to f6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Nc3: White reroutes a knight to c3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- a6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Be2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- e5: Black gains central space and a knight tempo while accepting a lasting weakness on d5.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

A lifetime repertoire grows from recurring decisions in your games, not from collecting every database branch at once.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

At what move did your reasoning disappear, and what one decision rule would restore it next time? White's resistance is: Opponents will choose sidelines and imperfect moves; those are tests of understanding rather than failures of preparation. The line fails as a template when: Replacing the whole opening after one loss or adding hundreds of moves without retrieval practice.

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COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

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1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

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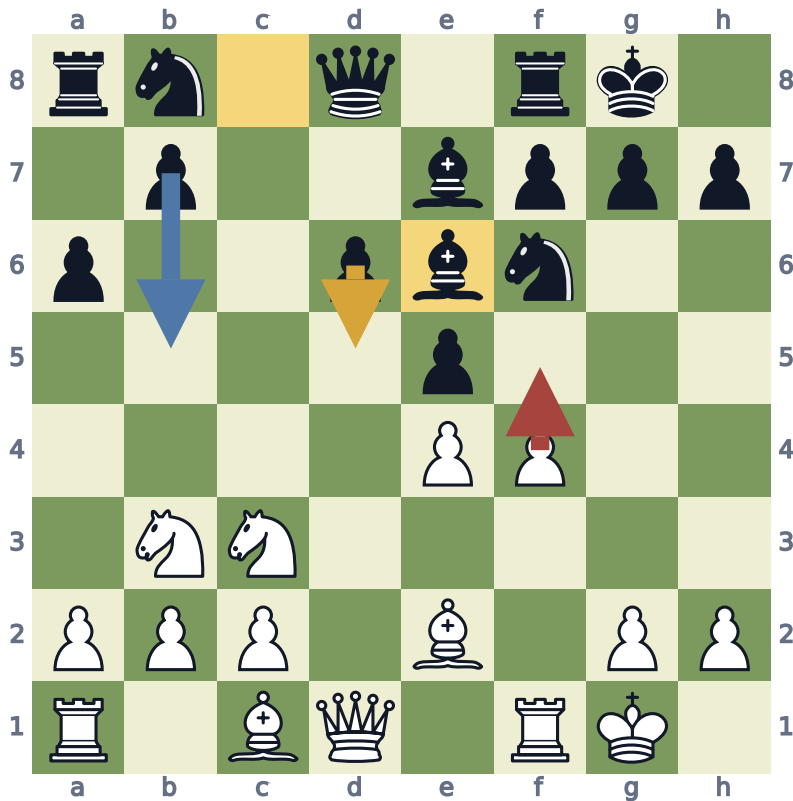
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be2 e5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Repairing the repertoire from your games



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

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DECISION RULE

At what move did your reasoning disappear, and what one decision rule would restore it next time?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

After each game, find the first position you could not explain, record the cue and candidate set, then repair only that branch.

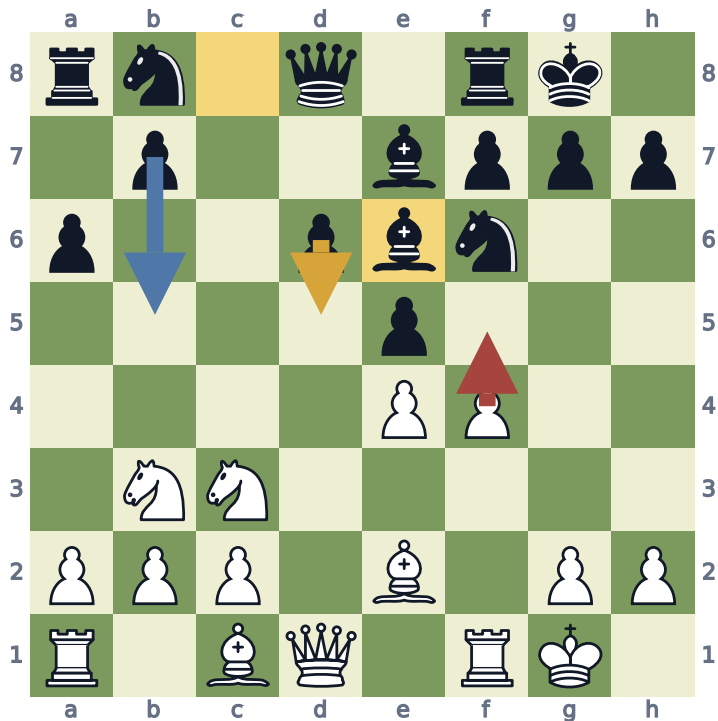
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

Opponents will choose sidelines and imperfect moves; those are tests of understanding rather than failures of preparation.

MEMORY RULE | Repair the first unexplained decision, then test it again.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

A lifetime repertoire grows from recurring decisions in your games, not from collecting every database branch at once.

BLACK AIMS FOR

After each game, find the first position you could not explain, record the cue and candidate set, then repair only that branch.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

Opponents will choose sidelines and imperfect moves; those are tests of understanding rather than failures of preparation.

FAILURE MODE

Replacing the whole opening after one loss or adding hundreds of moves without retrieval practice.

DECISION TEST

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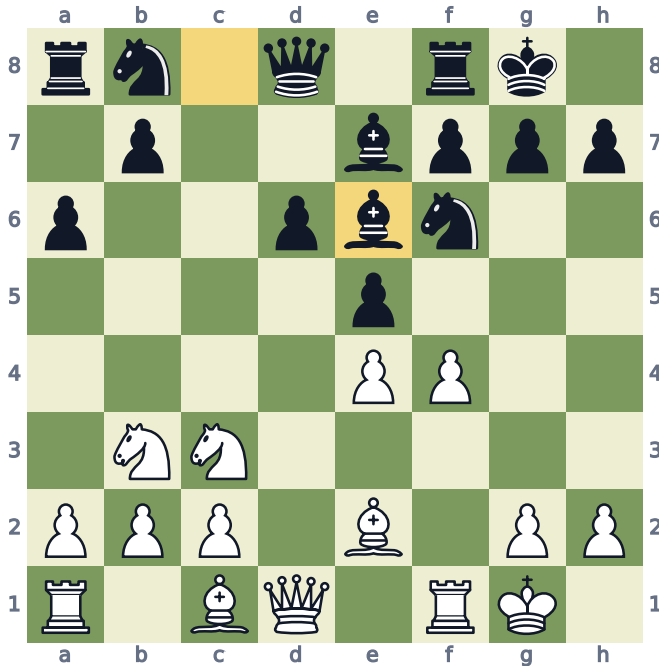
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be2 e5 7. Nb3 Be7 8. O-O O-O 9. f4 Be6



- Nb3: White reroutes a knight to b3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Be7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- O-O: Black secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- f4: White claims kingside space and announces e5 or f5 attacking ideas.
- Be6: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

A lifetime repertoire grows from recurring decisions in your games, not from collecting every database branch at once.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

At what move did your reasoning disappear, and what one decision rule would restore it next time? White's resistance is: Opponents will choose sidelines and imperfect moves; those are tests of understanding rather than failures of preparation. The line fails as a template when: Replacing the whole opening after one loss or adding hundreds of moves without retrieval practice.

STORE THIS | Repair the first unexplained decision, then test it again.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. A lifetime repertoire grows from recurring decisions in your games, not from collecting every database branch at once. 2. After each game, find the first position you could not explain, record the cue and candidate set, then repair only that branch. 3. Opponents will choose sidelines and imperfect moves; those are tests of understanding rather than failures of preparation. 4. At what move did your reasoning disappear, and what one decision rule would restore it next time? 5. Replacing the whole opening after one loss or adding hundreds of moves without retrieval practice.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. Nb3 Be7 8. O-O O-O 9. f4 Be6

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 103 Decode: Main-line rehearsal

Prompt: Which move is essential to the position, and which move belongs only to the memorized order?

Recall: Store structures and decisions; use move order only to reach them safely.

LESSON 104 Play: Main-line rehearsal

Prompt: Which move is essential to the position, and which move belongs only to the memorized order?

Recall: Store structures and decisions; use move order only to reach them safely.

LESSON 105 Decode: Anti-Sicilian decision tree

Prompt: What pawn break is White preparing, and which black move challenges it most directly?

Recall: Name White's center first; the anti-Sicilian label comes second.

LESSON 106 Play: Anti-Sicilian decision tree

Prompt: What pawn break is White preparing, and which black move challenges it most directly?

Recall: Name White's center first; the anti-Sicilian label comes second.

LESSON 107 Decode: Repairing the repertoire from your games

Prompt: At what move did your reasoning disappear, and what one decision rule would restore it next time?

Recall: Repair the first unexplained decision, then test it again.

LESSON 108 Play: Repairing the repertoire from your games

Prompt: At what move did your reasoning disappear, and what one decision rule would restore it next time?

Recall: Repair the first unexplained decision, then test it again.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's plan, White's counterplay, one candidate, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

Main-line rehearsal

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be3 e6 7. f3 b5 8. Qd2 Nbd7 9. g4 h6 10. O-O-O Bb7 11. Kb1 Rc8

Decision: Which move is essential to the position, and which move belongs only to the memorized order?

Memory: Store structures and decisions; use move order only to reach them safely.

CARD 2

Anti-Sicilian decision tree

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. Bb5+ Bd7 4. Bxd7+ Qxd7 5. O-O Nc6 6. c3 Nf6 7. Re1 g6 8. d4

Decision: What pawn break is White preparing, and which black move challenges it most directly?

Memory: Name White's center first; the anti-Sicilian label comes second.

CARD 3

Repairing the repertoire from your games

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be2 e5 7. Nb3 Be7 8. O-O O-O 9. f4 Be6

Decision: At what move did your reasoning disappear, and what one decision rule would restore it next time?

Memory: Repair the first unexplained decision, then test it again.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
103 Decode: Main-line rehearsal	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
104 Play: Main-line rehearsal	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
105 Decode: Anti-Sicilian decision tree	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
106 Play: Anti-Sicilian decision tree	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
107 Decode: Repairing the repertoire from your games	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
108 Play: Repairing the repertoire from your games	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name White's best counterplay, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.